Tier 2 | Add models without losing control

LARKSPUR CLAIMS | OFFLINE-FIRST PRACTICE COURSE

Model factory
Use common.models.get_chat_model(). Graded runs use scripted responses, temperature zero, no credentials, and no network.

Message history
Preserve AI tool-call IDs and matching tool responses. Use add_messages for message identity-aware updates.

Structured output
Validate fields with Pydantic and explicit constraints. Model text cannot grant approval or establish ownership.

Tools
Expose the smallest capability. Validate arguments and trust runtime context, not a model-supplied customer ID.

Agent loop
Use create_agent for a standard model/tool loop. Use an explicit graph when routing or authorization must be fixed.

Middleware
Place limits and hooks at the boundary they control. Bound model calls, tool calls, and recursion separately.

Memory
Checkpoints retain a thread. Store namespaces retain cross-thread facts. Trim or summarize deliberately; do not erase pending tool pairs.

RAG
Retrieve evidence, retain source IDs, answer only from support, and abstain when the corpus does not answer the question.

Practice
Modules 08-12; compare default, missing, malformed, and rejection cases. Checkpoint project: Policy Q&A with Memory.

Verified 2026-11-06. Core Python output: v2. Optional Beta APIs: B4.
Sources and pinned versions: docs/VERIFICATION_NOTES.md